

Delhi in late-August, will witness the capital hosting some of the biggest global and Indian industry leaders including Shantanu Narayen, Chair and CEO of Adobe; Michael Miebach, CEO of Mastercard; Arvind Krishna, Chairman and CEO of IBM; Dilhan Pillay Sandrasegara, ED and CEO of Temasek; Sunil Bharti Mittal, Chairman of Bharti Enterprises; and T.V. Narendran, CEO and MD, Tata Steel. N. Chandrasekaran, the Chairman of Tata Sons, is the B20 India Chair.

A NEW WORLD ORDER

But that is not all. India has also taken up other meatier issues during its G20 presidency that would help define the new world order.

One of the most important issues that India chose to tackle during its presidency is the reform and strengthening of MDBs. The G20's Independent Expert Group (IEG) led jointly by former US Treasury Secretary Lawrence Summers and N.K. Singh, Chairman of the 15th Finance Commission, recently presented the first volume of its report, which among other measures, has prescribed a triple-funding method through a Global Challenges Funding Mechanism that will allow for tapping into private sector investments that can help raise an additional \$20 billion for annual lending. At present, the two funding mechanisms are negotiated equity contributions from sovereign shareholders and discretionary trust funds. The second volume of the report is awaited.

"India's G20 leadership has opened new debates, brought new ideas and created new vocabularies on global issues. For example, the previous expert group on MDBs focussed primarily on the capital adequacy framework. But after the publication of the Singh-Summers Committee report, 'The Triple Agenda', there is a recognition that reforming MDBs will have to be carried out along three dimensions: expanding their mandate, tripling their finance and creating a third financing mechanism," explains Mishra of Icrier. The think tank and the Washington-based Centre for Global Develop-

ment have been appointed policy advisors to this IEG.

"Expanding the MDB reform agenda from one to three dimensions reflects the level of India's ambition," says Mishra. "Kudos to Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman for showing that India will not shy away from taking up some of the most difficult challenges facing the world economy and finding their solutions. This is the manifestation of a new India, a confident India and a global India."

Experts believe that India is a credible voice that can facilitate dialogue between the Global North and South and that further aids its G20 presidency. Deepa Kumar, Head of Asia-Pacific Country Risk at S&P Global Market Intelligence, says that the country is seeing itself as a bridge between advanced economies and emerging economies. "Many of the global shared challenges that are playing out today—climate change, energy transition or supply chain diversification—cannot be solved

by countries in isolation. The pandemic co-operation showed the world that you need to be able to work together. But what it also showed is that there is a divide in how you work across the Global North and South." India is realising that it is at the cusp where it can not only represent the challenges of the emerging economies, but can also work with its partners in the West—who are bullish about the country—to bridge that gap and make sure that there is some kind of consensus on how to approach global challenges, she adds.

Trying to bridge these differences, the Indian presidency is working to include the African Union as a member of the G20. Nagesh Kumar, Director and Chief Executive of the Institute for Studies in Industrial Development

(ISID), says that if this takes place, it will be an important and lasting legacy of the Indian presidency. "That will dramatically enhance the inclusiveness of this grouping," says Kumar of the New Delhi-based think tank, adding that it will make the G20 much more representative and inclusive than it is now.

India is also trying to reach a consensus on financial sector issues such as a global framework for regulating cryptocurrencies, as well as addressing debt vulnerabilities in low- and middle-income countries in an effective, comprehensive and systematic manner, which



The B20 has adopted RAISE or responsible, accelerated, innovative, sustainable, and equitable businesses